Light Cavalry in post-independent India. The Indian troops fought at Kaka, Arman Sagad and Dushak but because of the collapse of the anti-Bolshevik forces in April 1919, Malleson was forced to withdraw from Russian Turkestan in April 1919. The reach of the British Empire had finally been extended into Russian soil.

Wary of the British might, the Bolsheviks decided to counter-attack and the Third Comintern organised the First Congress of the Peoples of the East at Baku in September 1920. The Congress specifically aimed at fighting imperialism in Asia. Baku, in Soviet-controlled Azerbaijan, was only 2,000 km from Merv. Tashkent, where the Communist Party of India was formed on 17 October 1920, was only 900 km away from Merv. The Communist Party of India's two main founders of Indian origin were M. N. Roy and Abani Mukherjee.

The seeds of the old British-Russian enmity had now flowered into a new confrontation between the Government of India and Soviet Russia. Kashmir, once again, became the underbelly of this dispute. Abani Mukherjee, an associate of Rash Behari Bose, had already been jailed in Singapore for procuring weapons for use in the Hindu-German conspiracy of 1914–17. The objective of this conspiracy was to foment rebellion in the Indian Army, all the way from Punjab to Singapore. Mukherjee escaped from the Fort Canning prison in Singapore in 1917 and made his way to Moscow. M. N. Roy had also participated in the Hindu-German conspiracy and, escaping from British detention, made his way to Moscow via the US and Mexico.

It was against this backdrop in 1920 that a worried Government of India established the Council of State in Kashmir.[20] This was a successor to the Council of Regency which was dissolved in 1905. After Amar Singh's death in 1910, his son and British-supported heir to the throne of Jammu and Kashmir, Hari Singh, took his father's place as a senior member of the council. His task was to shadow the Maharaja in much the same way his father had done in the past.[21] This further fuelled Pratap Singh's existing animosity towards Hari Singh, who had literally been foisted upon him by the British. Pratap Singh died in 1925, a frustrated and embittered man who